Shanmukh Upadhyayula

312-805-4303 | shanmukh.upad@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/shanmukh-upadhyayula | github.com/ShanmukhUpad | shanmukhupad.github.io/portfolio

Education

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign GPA: 3.95/4.0

Master of Computer Science (MCS), Planned *August 2027 – May 2028*

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science & Geographic Information Science *August 2024 – May 2027*

- Relevant Coursework: Applied Linear Algebra, Data Structures, Algorithms & Models of Computation, Computer Systems, Virtual Reality, Spatial Analysis, Database Management in the Cloud

Experience

UIUC CyberGIS Lab Urbana, IL

Machine Learning Engineering Intern *September 2026 – Present*

- Testing and improving I-GUIDE's geospatial AI agent, an LLM system that writes and runs GIS code for researchers from plain-language requests
- Benchmarking the agent on GeoAnalystBench (48/50 tasks solved, over-planning on 43/48) and identifying flawed expert ground truth that skews LLM scoring
- Uncovering 2 silent failure modes, partial file reads and wrong CRS units causing a 10x area error, by designing trap datasets with known answers

Semantic Segmentation Failure Analysis Urbana, IL

Undergraduate Researcher | shanmukhupad.github.io/portfolio/seg.pdf *May 2026 – August 2026*

- Trained a DeepLabV3-ResNet50 semantic segmentation model in PyTorch on aerial imagery, and wrote an IEEE-format paper presented at a CyberGIS talk
- Diagnosed failure modes through boundary, class, and confidence analysis, finding 2x lower IoU near class edges and high confidence on misclassified pixels
- Cut the error rate from 51% to under 10% on unseen German imagery by building label-free uncertainty scoring (entropy, margin, confidence) to filter unreliable pixels
- Built a sliding-window inference tool generating full-resolution uncertainty maps to rank images for review

ACM SIG-CHI | github.com/sigchi-uiuc/digital-diary Urbana, IL

Project Lead *September 2025 – April 2026*

- Built real-time, hands-free mood logging from webcam video via MediaPipe hand landmarks and thumb angle
- Added facial-expression mood detection from MediaPipe face blendshapes (smile, frown, brow, cheek)
- Led a 15-person team shipping a Next.js journaling app integrating mood detection, Claude API, and Google Calendar

UIC Electronic Visualization Laboratory | github.com/ShanmukhUpad/curio Chicago, IL

Software Engineering Intern *June 2025 – August 2025*

- Cut processing time by about 30% across hundreds of urban data pipelines by building a Pandas merge tool
- Added dataset merging and multi-tab data views to Curio, a visual data-pipeline tool for researchers

Projects

Urban AR GIS: Hand-Tracked 3D City Viewer | github.com/ShanmukhUpad/urban-ar-gis March 2026

- Built a gesture-controlled 3D city viewer with MediaPipe hand tracking (clench to zoom, point to pan, grab to move)
- Kept real-time rendering smooth by running hand tracking on a separate thread from the ModernGL renderer

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, C++, C, Java, SQL, R
Computer Vision: PyTorch, torchvision, OpenCV, MediaPipe, NumPy, ModernGL/GLSL
Tools: Git, Docker, FastAPI, Linux, Google Cloud, GeoPandas, ArcGIS Pro